



FORM/CUE/Acc./9

**GUIDELINES  
FOR DESIGNING CURRICULUM  
FOR  
UNIVERSITY ACADEMIC PROGRAMMES**

**JANUARY 2023**

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## **SECTION A: SCOPE**

1. These guidelines shall apply to the design and development of curriculum for proposed and existing universities and institutions wishing to launch new academic programmes.
2. The guidelines shall be used together with the applicable *Universities Standards and Guidelines*.
3. The guidelines will apply to academic programmes in all modes of delivery – face to face, online, and blended.
4. The guidelines indicate the basic information that should be included in a curriculum for a university academic programme.

## **SECTION B: GUIDELINES**

### **1.0 GENERAL INFORMATION**

#### **1.1 Background Information of the Institution**

(Max 500 words)

#### **1.2 Vision and Mission of the Institution**

#### **1.3 Philosophy of the Institution**

Institutional beliefs, values, and tenets generated from the Vision and Mission.

*NB: Vision, mission and philosophy should be as stated in the Proposal or Charter.*

#### **1.4 University Admission Requirements**

**1.4.1**      *Minimum university entrance requirements;*

**1.4.2**      *Other admission requirements (where applicable); and*

**1.4.3**      *Procedure of application for admission to the University.*

#### **1.5 Academic Resources at the Institution**

**1.5.1**      *Facilities and Equipment*

Provide a summary of the facilities and equipment available to support the programmes at the university (e.g. the university has the following complement of facilities and equipment: 4 computer laboratories, 12 seminar rooms, 5 science laboratories, 60 lecture rooms, 1 library, 300 computers, 15 mbps internet etc).

### **1.5.2      *Reference materials***

Provide a summary of the number of texts, subscriptions to e-books and e-journals, number of print journals, and accessible databases.

### **1.5.3      *Academic and Support/Technical Staff***

An overview of staffing levels in terms of numbers by academic rank, and the relevant technical and support staff in direct support of university programmes.

## **1.6      Programmes Offered by the Institution**

### **1.6.1      *Academic programmes offered in the institution***

In tabular form, provide a list of all academic programmes offered by the institution, indicating the duration, total instructional hours required for graduation, and mode of delivery (face to face, blended or online).

### **1.6.2      *Definitions of:***

- (i)      Credit hours
- (ii)     Lecture/Instructional hours
- (iii)    Contact hours
- (iv)    Course units

NB:    In the case of ODeL, illustrate how course related learning activities are equated to instructional hours

### **1.6.3      *Academic                      organization of the programmes reflecting academic quarters/ trimesters/ semesters***

## **2.0      THE CURRICULUM**

### **2.1      Title of the Proposed Programme**

The title should be reflective of the content of the programme, as specified in PROG/STD/05

### **2.2      Philosophy of the Programme**

The underlying philosophy of the programme should be consistent with the institutional philosophy.

### **2.3      Rationale of the Programme**

The rationale of the programme should be informed by:

- a) Results of a needs assessment/market survey/situation analysis;
- b) Engagement of relevant external and internal stakeholders; and
- c) Justification of the need for the programme, incorporating emerging national, regional and global trends.

## **2.4 Goal of the Programme**

The goal of the programme should clearly be articulated, appropriate, and realistic. It should demonstrate a relationship to the institution's vision and mission, the general purpose, and the expected impact of the programme.

## **2.5 Expected Learning Outcomes of the programme**

The expected learning outcomes of the programme should:

- d) Be precise and concise;
- e) Include specific knowledge, skills, areas of professional development and attitudes that students are expected to have acquired and mastered by the end of the programme (refer to the Revised Bloom's Taxonomy of Learning Domains);
- f) SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, and Time- Bound) and learner-centered; and

In cases where the programme has specialization/option areas, the expected learning outcomes of the specialization areas should be included.

## **2.6 Mode of Delivery of the Programme**

The mode of delivery of the programme shall be clearly articulated and resonate with the programme content design. The mode shall be face to face, blended, or online.

In the case of blended mode of delivery, the percentage of the content to be delivered online and through face to face should be indicated, and shall not be less than 40% for either.

## **2.7 Academic Regulations for the Proposed Programme**

### **2.7.1 Admission Requirements for the Proposed Programme**

These should include:

- a) The minimum requirements applicable to candidates directly out of secondary school education and seeking admission into the programme; and
- b) Alternative requirements applicable to candidates seeking admission into the programme, including indirect admission requirements.

## **2.7.2      *Regulations on Credit Accumulation and Transfer in a programme***

### **2.7.2.1      Credit Accumulation**

Regulations on credit accumulation, including possible pathways, shall be in line with the provisions of Universities Regulations, Universities Standards and Guidelines, and general national trends.

### **2.7.2.2      Credit Transfer**

- (i) The regulations for credit transfer shall be in line with the general national trends
- (ii) The regulations for credit transfer shall be well articulated and include:
  - Type of certifications recognized;
  - Maximum number of credits permissible;
  - Level of courses eligible; and
  - Minimum grade required.

## **2.7.3      *Course Requirements***

These should include all requirements of the programme such as:

### **a) Obligations of the student**

- (i) Class attendance;
- (ii) Attachment/practicum/internship;
- (iii) Community service;
- (iv) Participation in interactive and collaborative activities;
- (v) Participation in orientation; and
- (vi) Submission of assignments.

### **b) Obligations of the lecturer**

- (i) Course set up, preparation of course content and delivery, and facilitation;
- (ii) Assessment and provision of feedback;
- (iii) Instructor presence beyond the class interaction hours;
- (iv) Online interaction with students (where applicable);
- (v) Monitoring students' progress and provision of guidance and support where necessary; and
- (vi) Attention to diverse needs of students (provision for individual differences).

### **c) Obligations of the Institution**

Where applicable and based on the mode of delivery, the institution shall outline the obligations of the

institution on the following:

- (i) Provision of information resources and appropriate technologies, such as Learning Management System (LMS), computers and internet, and the technical support to use it
- (ii) Provide appropriate digital learning materials and resources
- (iii) Provision of a safe learning environment, Data protection, intellectual property rights and copyright, and academic integrity of online courses
- (iv) Provision of guidelines for communication between student and lecturer

#### **2.7.4 Student Assessment at programme level**

This should include:

- (i) Summary of the University criteria on assessment, including goals for assessment, strategies of ensuring academic integrity, security, reliability, validity, fairness and accuracy of tests
- (ii) Diversity of assessment modes, including summative and formative
- (iii) Assessment of practicals, practicum and community service
- (iv) Authentic assessment
- (v) Authentication of student's work

#### **2.7.5 Grading System**

The system should indicate marks and letter grades with a clear and objective definition of each grade and an explanation of the criteria and impact on the overall grade, progression, and/or graduation.

#### **2.7.6 Examination Regulations**

Provisions of the institution's Examination Policy, the examination regulations shall be well articulated to include: security of exams, tools and methods, protocols, student authentication methods, authentication of student's work in examinations, examination malpractices, disciplinary action, and mode of appeal

#### **2.7.7 Moderation of Examinations**

The process of moderation, including the procedure, security of examination and the role of internal and external examiners are appropriate

#### **2.7.8 Graduation Requirements**

The graduation requirements should be explicitly provided and should include the passmark and the total number of units/credits/lecture/instructional hours and/or publication(s) in referenced journals required for graduation purposes.

### **2.7.9      *Classification of the Degree/Non-degree Awards***

Where applicable, state the classification of the degree/non-degree awards

### **2.7.10      *Description of Thesis/Dissertation/Project***

Where applicable, describe Thesis/ Dissertation/ Project requirements including:

- (i) Institutional definition of thesis/dissertation/project;
- (ii) Rationale of the thesis/dissertation/project in the programme;
- (iii) Facets of the thesis/dissertation/project;
- (iv) Regulations of the thesis/dissertation/project, which should entail among others, criteria and process of supervision and the role of both the lecturer and the student.
- (v) Authentication of students and students' work
- (vi) Requirements on publication

## **2.8      Student Evaluation of Course**

Expound on student evaluation of course, including:

- (i) Goal and procedure of course evaluation
- (ii) Student self-evaluation
- (iii) Course content, instructional process, infrastructure and equipment for the course delivery, instructional and study materials, and assessments
- (iv) Management of feedback from the student

## **2.9      Management and Administration of the Programme**

This should include:

- (i) Programme placement/housing, academic leadership and management and administrative structures;
- (ii) Interface between the respective academic units that is teaching the programme, ICT, ODeL and support services in place including ownership of the programme
- (iii) Internal quality assurance mechanisms including monitoring of the programme, curriculum review and the role of the curriculum committee(s)

## 2.10 Courses /Units Offered for the Programme

The courses/units offered for the programme should include:

### 2.10.1 A course distribution table

Comprising of a summary of course title, mode of delivery, the number of courses/units/credit hours/lecture hours allocated to the institution's common courses, core courses of the programme, specialization area courses and electives

|                         |        | Number | Credit Hours | Lecture Hours | Mode of Delivery |
|-------------------------|--------|--------|--------------|---------------|------------------|
| University Common Units |        |        |              |               |                  |
| Core Course Units       | Year 1 |        |              |               |                  |
| Electives               | Year 1 |        |              |               |                  |
| Total                   |        |        |              |               |                  |

### 2.10.2 A course matrix

Showing the courses that are covered by each expected learning outcomes of the programme and specialization areas. A template of the matrix is hereby provided:

| LEARNING OUTCOMES                       |                       | YEAR 1                |         | YEAR 2                |         | YEAR 3                |         | YEAR 4                |  |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------|-----------------------|---------|-----------------------|---------|-----------------------|--|
| PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES (PLOs)      |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
|                                         | Courses               | Credit /Lecture hours | Courses | Credit /Lecture hours | Courses | Credit /Lecture hours | Courses | Credit /Lecture hours |  |
| PLO 1                                   | A<br>B<br>C<br>D<br>E |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| PLO 2                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| PLO 3                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| PLO 4                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SPECIALIZATION LEARNING OUTCOMES (SLOs) |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| Specialization 1                        |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 1                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 2                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 3                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| Specialization 2                        |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 1                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 2                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |
| SLO 3                                   |                       |                       |         |                       |         |                       |         |                       |  |

### 2.10.3 Common courses of the institution, core courses of the programme, specialization area courses, and electives

Provide a list of the institution's common courses, core courses of the programme, specialization area courses, and electives. For each course include:

- Course codes, which should reveal the programme type, specialization area, level and year of study and should be unique to every course;
- Course titles, which should be descriptive of the content of the course; and
- Credit hours and/or lecture hours.

#### **2.10.4 Programme courses per semester per subject per discipline**

Provide a list of the programme's courses to be taken by the students by quarter/trimester/semester per subject /discipline including the:

- (i) Minimum lecturer workload for the course, which should include preparation time for teaching and practical, actual teaching time, setting, and administering and marking of continuous assessments and final examinations.
- (ii) Minimum student workload for the course, which should include attending lectures, seminars, independent/private study, interactive activities, assignments, practicals, preparation for and sitting for continuous assessments, and final examinations.

#### **2.10.5 Total credit hours, lecture hours, contact hours and course units required for graduation**

This should be in conformity with the Universities Standards and Guidelines and the minimum national standards (where available) .

### **2.11 Duration and Structure of the Programme**

This should include the number of academic years, credit/ lecture/contact hours and a table indicating the schedule of courses/ course units per semester/trimester/quarter.

For ODeL, define the minimum number of units/courses amounting to a module and the minimum modules for which a student is expected to register (where applicable).

## **3.0 COURSE OUTLINES**

NB: For courses offered under online and blended modes of delivery, an institution shall be required to translate the design plans provided in the course outlines into course materials and upload the same into the Learning Management System (LMS) ahead of the Commission's resource verification visit.

### **3.1 Title of the course**

This should include the course code, title, and credit hours/lecture hours/course units

*NB: Prerequisites should be indicated where applicable*

### **3.2 Purpose of the course**

A brief statement on the desired impact of the course/what the course is intended to achieve.

### **3.3 Expected Learning Outcomes of the Course**

The expected learning outcomes of the course should:

- (i) Include statements of knowledge, skills, and attitude that the student would be expected to acquire, and the tasks a learner is expected to perform or accomplish after taking the particular course; and
- (ii) Be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, and Time-Bound (SMART) and learner-centered.

### **3.4 Course Content**

Course content should :

- Be clearly articulated with topical and sub-topical areas to be covered in the course;
- Be relevant to the course in focus and presented in a systematic manner;
- Comprehensively address the expected learning outcomes of the courses in focus; and
- Be sufficient for the duration allocated to the various courses.

### **3.5 Instructional methods**

The instructional methods should:

- (i) Be appropriate for the nature of the courses in focus, promote student engagement, and include interactive and collaborative activities;
- (ii) Provide for instructor presence and promote cognitive, social and teaching presence; and
- (iii) Comprehensively provide a range and variety of methods, including but not limited to: experiential and activity-based learning.

### **3.6 Instructional Materials and/or Equipment**

The instructional materials and/or equipment should:

- (i) Be appropriate for the nature of the courses in focus;
- (ii) Be comprehensively provided and include Self Learning Materials;
- (iii) Resonate with the programmes's student assessment criteria; and
- (iv) Be appropriate for the nature of the course in focus.

### **3.7 Student Assessment at course level**

Provide appropriate student assessment that:

- (i) Resonates with the programmes's student assessment policy/criteria; and
- (ii) Is appropriate for the nature of the courses in focus.

### **3.8 Core Reading Materials for the Course**

- a) A uniform referencing style should be adopted and consistently applied to all course outlines of the programme;
- b) The materials should be relevant, current (not more than five years old unless they are classical references), and diversified to include print and e- books and journals, and other e-materials; and
- c) The list of core reading materials should include reading materials by local authors and/or have local context.

### **3.9 Recommended Reference Materials for the Course**

- a) A uniform referencing style should be adopted and consistently applied to all course outlines of the programme
- b) The materials should be relevant, current (not more than five years old unless they are classical references), and diversified to include print and e- books and journals, and other e-materials.
- c) The list of recommended reading materials should include reading materials by local authors and/or have local context.

### **3.10 Design Plan**

For ODeL courses, provide, in a tabular form, a design plan that shall include course content (topic/subtopic), the learning outcomes, activity description, technology requirements, teaching/ facilitation requirements, duration, and instructional hour equivalent for the respective activities.

### Format of the Design Plan

| Course content<br>(topic/subtopic)                                                    | Learning<br>outcomes                                       | Activity<br>description                                                                  | Technology<br>requirements                                                                                                                                                    | Teaching/facilitation<br>requirements                                                                       | Duration              | Instructional<br>hour<br>equivalent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Example:</b><br><i>Introduction to<br/>computers:<br/>history of<br/>computers</i> | <i>Describe<br/>the<br/>evolution<br/>of<br/>computers</i> | <i>online<br/>discussion/<br/>video on<br/>the how<br/>computer<br/>have<br/>evolved</i> | <i>E- and physical<br/>library resources<br/>E-learning<br/>materials<br/>Internet access<br/>Computers<br/>Human resources<br/>Classrooms<br/>Administrative<br/>offices</i> | <i>Introductory lecture<br/>Video<br/>Recommended reading<br/>Discussion forum<br/>provide feedback etc</i> | <i>30<br/>minutes</i> |                                     |

## **4.0 APPENDICES**

### **4.1 Appendix I: Facilities**

Checklist of facilities should include the number, capacity and usage (specific to department/shared) of facilities such as conferencing halls, lecture rooms and theaters, lecturers' offices, laboratories, workshops, studios, multimedia production rooms, server rooms, student support rooms, assistive facilities, farm and field facilities and internet access points.

### **4.2 Appendix II: Equipment and Teaching Materials**

Checklist of equipment and teaching materials should include type, number, capacity and usage (specific to department/shared) of desktop computers (PCs), laptops/notebooks, servers, LMS, smart and interactive boards, online support system, help desk, projectors, internet bandwidth, conferencing equipment, computer software, laboratory equipment and special equipment.

In addition, the University should provide a description of the LMS in use, related infrastructure, and a screenshot of the landing page.

### **4.3 Appendix III: Core-Texts and Journals**

List of core texts and journals, which should encompass subject areas, and number of titles and volumes for both print and electronic materials.

### **4.4 Appendix IV: Academic Staff and Support/Technical Staff**

List of teaching staff comprehensively provided to include name, academic rank, specification of the academic leader, qualifications, when and where the qualification was earned, area (s) of specialization, experience (in years) in university teaching and/or professional experience, terms of engagement, workload (number of hours per week, including teaching load from other programmes); list of publications and patents. The academic leader of the programme should be indicated. Show qualifications for:

- (i) Bachelor's Degree
- (ii) Master's Degree
- (iii) Doctoral Degree

List of relevant support/technical staff comprehensively provided to include name, designation, qualifications, when and where the qualification was earned, area(s) of specialization, working experience (in years), and terms of engagement

#### **4.5 Appendix V: Needs Assessment/Market Survey/ Situational Analysis Report**

#### **4.6 Appendix VI: Stakeholder Engagement Report**

#### **4.7 Appendix VII: University Policy on Curriculum Development and Review**

The Policy shall provide for:

- a) Process for development and review of a curriculum, including relevant surveys and assessments informing curriculum review;
- b) Role of the different parties/stakeholders;
- c) Review period; and
- d) Approval levels, including provision for prior approval by the Commission before mounting a proposed programme.

Note:

*Academic programmes submitted to the Commission for University Education must be approved by the relevant organs of the institution. Such organs include the Senate/Academic Board in established Universities and Interim Technical Committees for proposed institutions.*

***Disclaimer:***

*The Commission for University Education reserves the right to amend the content of these guidelines without notice. Institutions should obtain the latest edition from the Commission.*

***January 2023***